

HOW YOU TEST IN A RETAIL STORE

While it's difficult to test a projector fully at a retail store, here are a few things that you can try to discern from a projector sample in a store. Let's see how:



1 Brightness: Test the projector's brightness with a light meter app like Lux Meter (<https://goo.gl/x3U52l>) or Easy Light Meter (<https://goo.gl/85W3Kj>), which should give you a decent idea about the projector's brightness output.



4 Audio: Carry some of your favourite songs on a pendrive and try to play them off the projector that can play audio content off a pendrive. If a projector audio performs worse than a laptop's speaker, time to give that sample a skip.



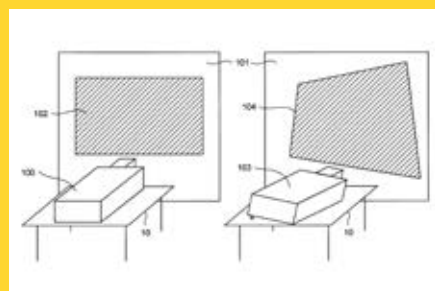
7 Connectivity: If wireless access to projectors is a big requirement, ensure you connect your laptop or smartphone wirelessly with the projector and try playing content through it. Also, make sure the audio ports are compatible with your stereo setup.



2 Videos: Load a few HQ 1080p videos onto a pendrive and try to convince the sales assistant to let you watch them, as they're crucial to let you decide whether you'll buy the device or not. Check for Rainbow or Moire on your videos.



5 Menu buttons: Whether you keep your projector on a desk or hang it upside down, menu buttons are essential to get the job done, so make sure your projector doesn't skimp on this tiny little detail for your own future peace of mind.



8 Keystone: If your prospective projector comes with an auto keystone adjustment feature, try lifting the projector from the front (and changing its projection angle) and see if the keystone corrects itself in a few seconds. It really helps.



3 Rainbow, Moire Effect: These are visual aberrations in the projection. To see if a projector suffers from Moire effect, project a still white frame onto the screen. Rainbow effect is usually manifested while displaying a high frame rate action sequence and you see a hint of blue-red pattern at object edges.



6 Screen: A screen with a white foreground and a black background is recommended. It's also better to get a sheet suspended off a hook that can be folded later (priced around ₹1,500 for a 6-feet by 4-feet area) as compared to much costlier options depending on your budget would be good enough.



9 Temperature: Take a digital temperature thermometer along and ensure the test projector has been playing nonstop for at least 15-20 minutes before thrusting your thermometer's probe into the projector's heat vents. Let the temperature reading stabilize. Under or around 60°C - good. Beyond 75°C - bad.